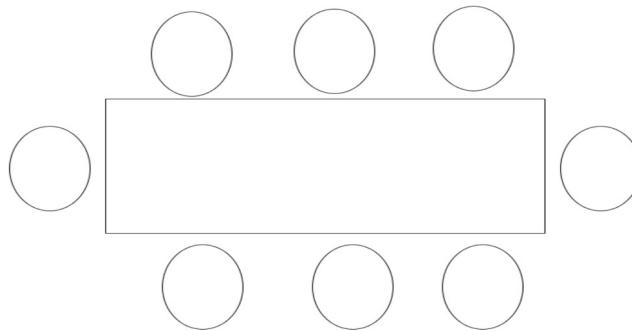


The Dinner Party

Scenario

You are hosting a dinner party that everyone will remember. You have received replies from twelve potential guests, but your table only has room for seven guests. Read each profile carefully before deciding

- a) who to invite.
- b) where they should sit (and where will you sit?)



As a group, agree on your guest list and be prepared to justify your choices.

1. Maya – Award-Winning Travel Writer (36)

Maya has travelled to more than 120 countries and has an incredible talent for storytelling. She can make almost any place sound fascinating and is genuinely interested in other people's cultures. However, she has very strong opinions about "authentic" travel and can be quite dismissive of package holidays, luxury resorts or people who only visit famous tourist attractions.

2. Daniel – Celebrity Chef (48)

Daniel owns several successful restaurants and has cooked for world leaders, actors and royalty. He is warm, funny and loves introducing people to new cuisines. However, he cannot resist commenting on every dish he eats and has been known to criticise restaurants (and even home cooking) without being asked.

3. Chloe – Social Media Influencer (29)

Chloe has over eight million followers and has built a successful business creating lifestyle content. She is energetic, outgoing and knows how to keep people entertained. However, she documents almost everything she does, often reaches for her phone during conversations, and believes experiences are worth sharing online immediately.

4. Professor Ahmed – Historian (61)

Professor Ahmed specialises in ancient civilisations and has spent decades excavating archaeological sites around the world. He has an endless collection of fascinating stories and enjoys connecting history with modern life. However, he has a habit of correcting even the smallest historical mistake, which can interrupt the flow of conversation.

5. Sofia – Environmental Campaigner (34)

Sofia has worked on conservation projects across four continents and is passionate about protecting the natural world. She asks thoughtful questions and enjoys discussing big global issues. However, she often challenges people about their lifestyle choices—from flying abroad to eating meat—and is not afraid to disagree if she feels strongly about something.

6. Leo – Stand-Up Comedian (40)

Leo can make almost anyone laugh and has a gift for making strangers feel comfortable within minutes. He enjoys telling stories and often breaks awkward silences with humour. However, he sometimes jokes at the wrong moment, struggles to take serious discussions seriously, and enjoys being the centre of attention.

7. Dr Aisha Khan – Astronaut (42)

Aisha recently returned from a six-month mission aboard the International Space Station. She has experienced things that very few people ever will and explains complex scientific ideas in an engaging way. However, she has little interest in celebrity culture or small talk and sometimes finds everyday conversations rather uninteresting.

8. Ethan – Technology Entrepreneur (38)

Ethan founded a successful artificial intelligence company before selling it for millions. He loves discussing innovation, solving problems and imagining the future. However, he believes technology is the solution to almost every problem and often interrupts conversations with, "AI could fix that."

9. Isabella – Crime Novelist (50)

Isabella has written several international bestsellers and is an excellent listener. She asks thoughtful questions and is genuinely curious about people's lives, often encouraging quieter guests to contribute. However, she enjoys analysing people's behaviour so much that others sometimes feel she is quietly judging them.

10. Noah – Wildlife Biologist (44)

Noah has spent years studying endangered animals in rainforests, deserts and polar regions. He is calm, patient and has incredible stories about working in remote places. However, he dislikes noisy environments, avoids arguments and may simply withdraw from the conversation if the atmosphere becomes too lively.

11. Priya – Entrepreneur & Investor (35)

Priya has built several successful businesses from scratch and enjoys mentoring young entrepreneurs. She is confident, optimistic and loves ambitious ideas. However, she naturally sees everything as a business opportunity and has a habit of asking people how they could "monetise" their hobbies or passions.

12. Marco – Retired International Football Referee (57)

Marco has officiated at World Cups and Champions League finals and has travelled extensively through sport. He is calm under pressure, diplomatic and has many entertaining stories about famous players and managers. However, he enjoys playing devil's advocate and will often argue the opposite side of a discussion simply to make it more interesting.

Your Task

As a group, decide which seven guests you would invite.

As you discuss, consider:

- Who would create the most interesting conversations?
- Which personalities would work well together?
- Which guests might clash?
- Who would encourage others to speak?
- Who might dominate the evening?
- How would you arrange the seating?
- What topics do you think would be discussed?
- Is there anyone you definitely would not invite? Why?

Be prepared to explain and justify your decisions to the rest of the class.